

Pre-work · The Respiratory and Lymphatic Systems

The Respiratory System and The Lymphatic System. Read both Part A chapters first. Give each one its own sitting, since this is your first full pass through both. Both systems are pathway systems, so the order of the parts is the content.

Module 4 · 1 of 5

Bring this to class

How to work this pre-work

1 min

The order you do these in matters more than the number of hours you put in. Context has to come before content. Almost every student who struggles with this course did all of the pieces, just not in the sequence that makes them work.

1 Start with the reading.

Open the Part A chapter and read it before you touch anything on this sheet. I have not repeated the chapter here, because this packet is where you put that reading to work.

2 Organize what you read.

In Panel 1, turn the reading into small visuals. Do not copy sentences across. The whole point is that you decide how it fits together.

3 Draw it.

In Panel 2, dump everything you can remember first, then draw it, then go back with a second color and correct yourself. The second color is the part that teaches you something.

4 Apply it.

Work Panel 3 with your notes closed the first time through. Open them afterward, only to check what you got.

5 Come back to it later in the week

, not the same night you drew it. Cover everything and redraw your visuals from memory. Whatever you cannot redraw is the part you have not learned yet, and it is much better to find that out now than on exam day.

Here is why the order works. Reading first gives you the context to hang everything else on. Organizing before you draw forces you to decide what connects to what, which is the thinking part. Drawing before you apply is where you find out what you actually know rather than what only looks familiar. If you jump straight to the application questions you will answer them with your notes open, and you will learn almost nothing from them.

Organize it

3 min

PANEL 1 OF 3

Turn the respiratory and lymphatic chapters into mini visuals. Nine chunks. Two chains carry the two pathways, and the pathways are where most of the marks are.

YOU ONLY NEED FIVE SHAPES

Information has a shape, and if you choose the wrong one your diagram turns into noise. Choose the one that actually fits and you will be able to redraw the whole thing from memory in about twenty seconds. Use a ladder for an ordered series, a chain with arrows for a sequence, a split for a pair you keep confusing, a hub for one structure with parts hanging off it, and a grid when two variables cross.

Your chunks for this packet

Each chunk gets one visual, in the shape that fits it, drawn on the mini visual sheet at the end of this packet. Each is made once, so nothing here is done twice. If a chunk takes longer than three minutes you are copying instead of organizing.

1 GRID

Two ways of grouping the parts

Structure down the side, nose to alveolus in order. Upper or lower in one column, conducting or respiratory in the other. Circle every row where the two columns disagree, because those rows are the questions.

2 HUB

The nasal cavity

One sagittal nasal cavity at the hub. Spoke to the three conchae and their meatuses, the septum with its three parts, the vestibule, the hard and soft palate, the choanae, and the four paranasal sinuses.

3 LADDER

The three regions of the pharynx

Three rungs, nasopharynx at the top. Beside each write what it carries, its epithelium, and its tonsil. Mark the rung where the epithelium changes and the rung where the air and food paths finally divide.

4 HUB

The larynx

The larynx at the hub. Spoke to the three single cartilages and the three paired ones, then to the vocal folds, the vestibular folds, and the glottis. Mark the one cartilage that is elastic and the one that is a complete ring.

5 CHAIN

The airway, trachea to alveolus

Trachea through terminal bronchiole, then on to the respiratory bronchiole, alveolar duct, and alveolus. Under the chain draw two bars, cartilage falling and smooth muscle rising, and mark the box where the conducting zone ends.

6 SPLIT

Right lung against left lung

Lobes, fissures, size, and the feature unique to each side. Then hang the parietal pleura, the visceral pleura, and the pleural cavity off both branches, since those three are the same on both sides.

7 CHAIN

The pathway of lymph, tissue space to bloodstream

Six boxes with arrows, lymphatic capillary through to the subclavian vein. Mark the box where the lymph is filtered, and write beside the last box that this is the single point where a one-way system finally meets the blood.

8 HUB

A lymph node

One bean-shaped node at the hub. Spoke to the capsule, cortex, medulla, and hilum. Draw several afferent vessels entering through the capsule and one efferent vessel leaving at the hilum, then write the three regions where nodes cluster.

9 GRID

Primary against secondary lymphatic organs

Organ down the side, six rows. Group, location, and role across the top. Only two rows can say primary, and the reason they do is the answer to the whole grid.

YOU KNOW PANEL 1 WORKED WHEN

Someone hands you a blank page and you can redraw any one of these from memory in under a minute, explaining it out loud while you draw.

Draw it

3 min

PANEL 2 OF 3

Panel 1 was the shape of the information. This is the structure itself, drawn from memory, then corrected.

HOW A BRAIN DUMP WORKS

Set a timer for two minutes. Close everything, write and sketch every piece you can recall on blank paper. Do not organize it. When the timer stops, then draw. The gap between the dump and the drawing is the part that teaches you.

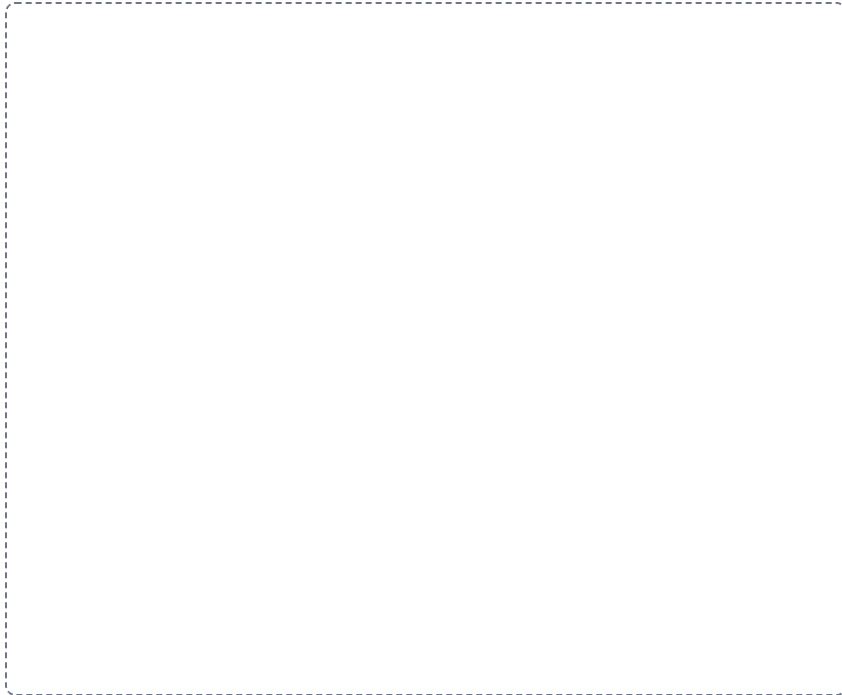
DRAWING 1

The lungs, the pleurae, and the bronchial tree

BRAIN DUMP FIRST

Two minutes. Both lungs with every lobe and fissure, the tree inside them, and the membranes around them.

Draw the trachea with its C-shaped cartilage rings and the carina below. Branch into both main bronchi and make the right one visibly wider and more vertical, then continue into lobar and segmental bronchi. Outline both lungs around the tree: three lobes and two fissures on the right, two lobes, one fissure, a cardiac notch, and the lingula on the left. Mark the apex, base, and hilum on each, then draw the parietal pleura against the chest wall, the visceral pleura on the lung surface, and the pleural cavity between them.



In your notebook, head the page **M4-1 The lungs, the pleurae, and the bronchial tree** so you can find it later. Correct it in a second color.

YOU KNOW IT WHEN

You can say which lung an inhaled bead lands in, and point at the two features on your own drawing that decided it.

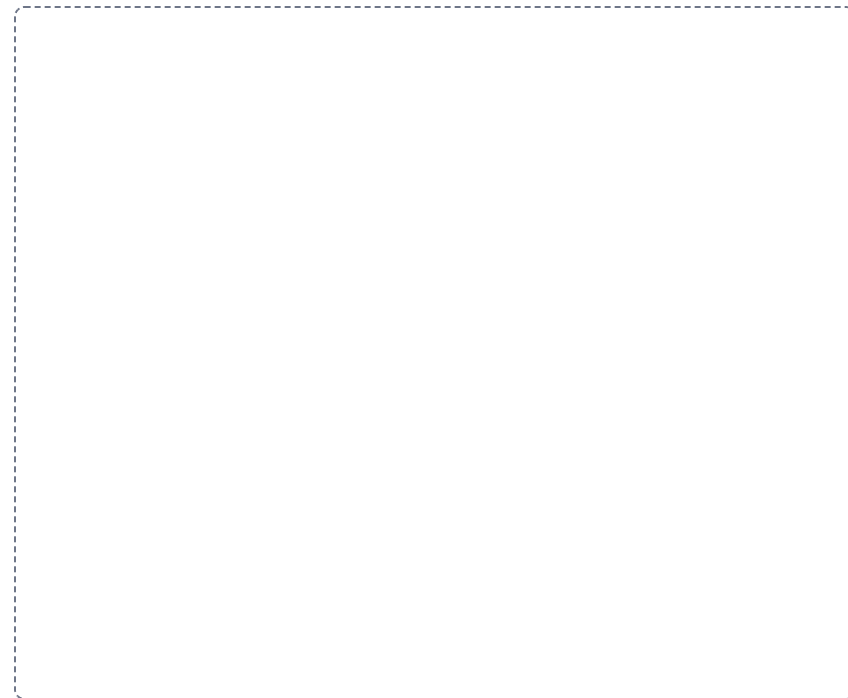
DRAWING 2

An alveolus and the respiratory membrane

BRAIN DUMP FIRST

One minute. Every cell of the alveolar wall and the three layers a gas crosses.

Draw one alveolar sac with several alveoli opening into it, at large scale. Line the wall with flat type I cells, add a few cuboidal type II cells, and put an alveolar macrophage on the surface. Wrap a pulmonary capillary against the outside, then enlarge the point where the two touch and label the alveolar epithelium, the fused basement membranes, and the capillary endothelium.



In your notebook, head the page **M4-2 An alveolus and the respiratory membrane** so you can find it later. Correct it in a second color.

YOU KNOW IT WHEN

You can point at what emphysema destroys on your own drawing and say why the loss is permanent.

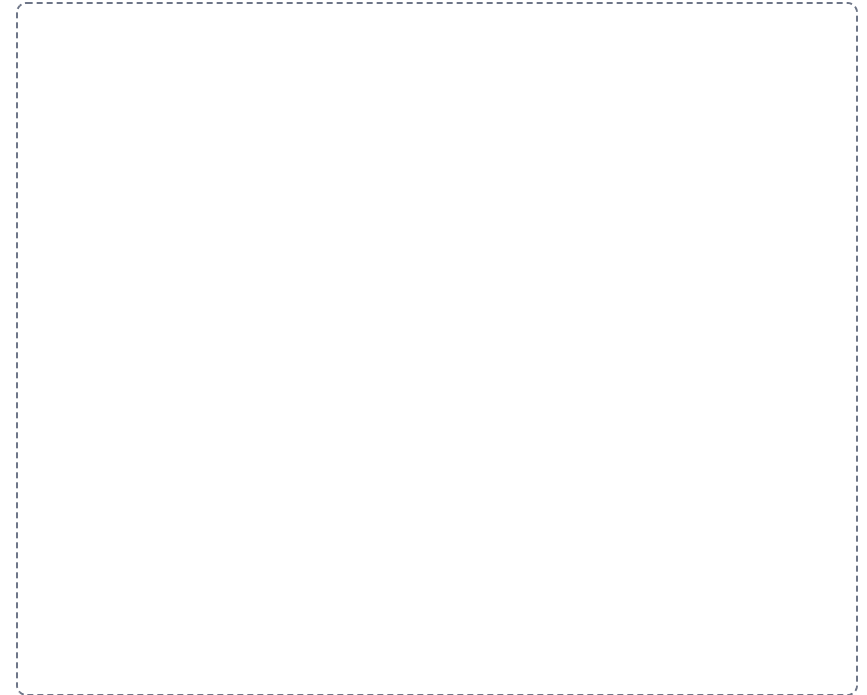
DRAWING 3

The lymphatic system, and a node in section

BRAIN DUMP FIRST

Two minutes. Where the lymph goes, which duct drains what, and what happens inside a node.

Draw a body outline. Shade the upper right quadrant one way and the rest of the body another, then draw the right lymphatic duct draining the shaded quadrant and the thoracic duct draining everything else, both emptying where the subclavian and internal jugular veins meet. Add the cisterna chyli at the start of the thoracic duct and mark the cervical, axillary, and inguinal clusters. Beside the outline draw one node cut open, with its capsule, cortex, medulla, several afferent vessels, and one efferent vessel at the hilum.



In your notebook, head the page **M4-3 The lymphatic system, and a node in section** so you can find it later. Correct it in a second color.

YOU KNOW IT WHEN

You can name which duct returns lymph from any region someone points to, and say why the two ducts are so unequal in size.

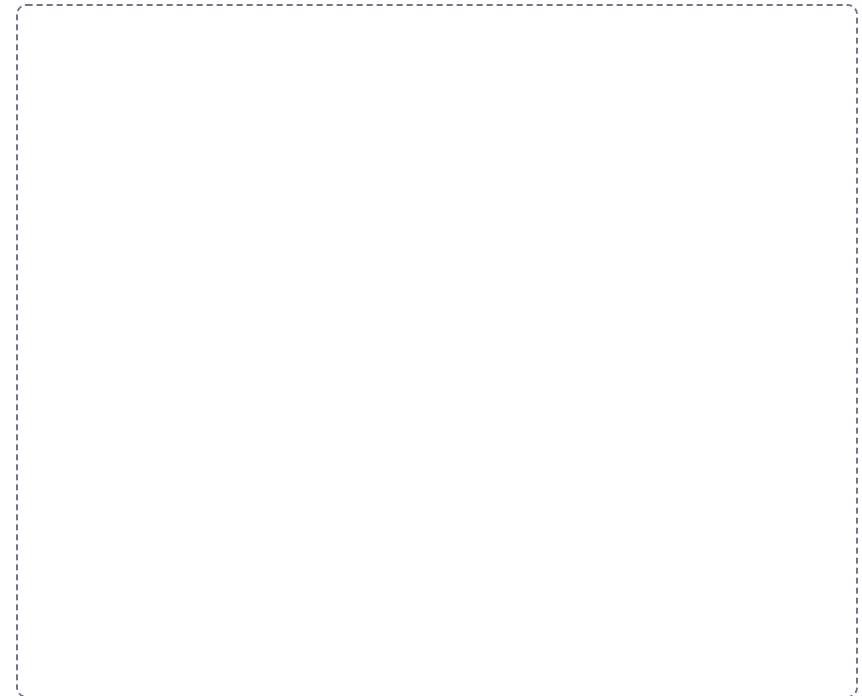
DRAWING 4

The upper respiratory tract, in sagittal section

BRAIN DUMP FIRST

Two minutes. Everything air passes through before the larynx.

Draw a head cut down the midline. Draw the nasal cavity with all three conchae and the meatus under each, the septum, the vestibule, the hard and soft palate, and the choanae. Mark the frontal and sphenoid sinuses. Then divide the pharynx into its three regions with lines, label each, and mark the epiglottis at the bottom.



In your notebook, head the page **M4-16 The upper respiratory tract, in sagittal section** so you can find it later. Correct it in a second color.

YOU KNOW IT WHEN

You can trace a breath from the nostril to the larynx on your own drawing, naming every space it crosses.

Apply it

2 min

PANEL 3 OF 3

First pass with everything closed. Then open the notes in a second color and mark what you missed.

WORKED EXAMPLE

After surgery for breast cancer a patient has had the axillary lymph nodes on one side removed. Months later that arm is persistently swollen. Name the condition and explain it from the structure of the system.

Answer. Lymphedema.

Reasoning. Start with what the lymphatic system does, not with the surgery. Lymphatic capillaries take up the fluid that leaks out of the blood capillaries and return it through collecting vessels, nodes, trunks, and ducts to the subclavian veins, so the whole thing is a one-way drain with no alternate route. Remove the axillary nodes and you remove the vessels that ran through them, and the lymph of that entire limb loses the road it was using. Fluid keeps arriving in the tissue spaces at the old rate but leaves more slowly, so it accumulates, and the swelling is the surplus. Ordinary edema would settle once its cause passed, which is what rules it out here, because the missing structure is not rebuilt. Notice that the arm swells and the trunk does not, and that tells you exactly where along the route the drainage was cut.

Set A · Name it

1. The scroll-shaped projections that swirl air in the nasal cavity are the _____.
2. The only complete cartilage ring in the airway is the _____.
3. The specialized lymphatic capillaries that absorb dietary fat in the small intestine are the _____.
4. The sac at the beginning of the thoracic duct is the _____.
5. Name the two primary lymphatic organs and say what matures in each.

Set B · Predict it

1. The chest wall is punctured and air enters the pleural cavity. Predict what happens to the lung and name the condition.

2. A patient loses the use of the skeletal muscles of one leg. Predict the effect on lymph return from that limb and say why.

3. A premature infant lacks surfactant. Predict what happens to the alveoli between breaths and name the cell that should have made it.

4. A blow to the lower left ribs is followed by heavy internal bleeding. Name the organ and explain why it bleeds so much.

Set C · Tell it apart

1. The larynx is in the lower respiratory tract but in the conducting zone. Explain how both are true.

2. Distinguish edema from lymphedema by the structure at fault in each.

3. Compare a lymphatic capillary with a blood capillary by how each one begins and how permeable each one is.

YOU KNOW PANEL 3 WORKED WHEN

Your first-pass answers and your corrections are in two different colors, and you can say out loud why each correction was a correction.

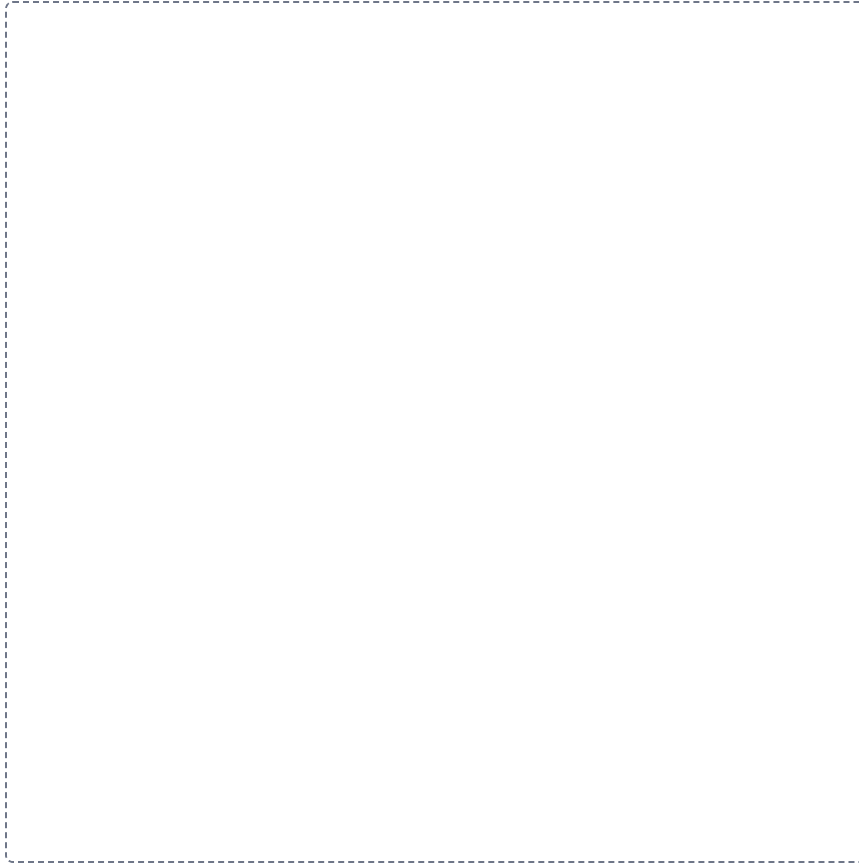
Mini visual sheet**2 min**

Each frame tells you what to draw in it and what to label. Do them with your notes closed, then open your notes and correct yourself in a second color. Draw straight onto this sheet. If a frame is too small for your handwriting, draw that one in your notebook instead and write the frame number at the top of the page so you can find it again.

Two ways of grouping the parts

GRID

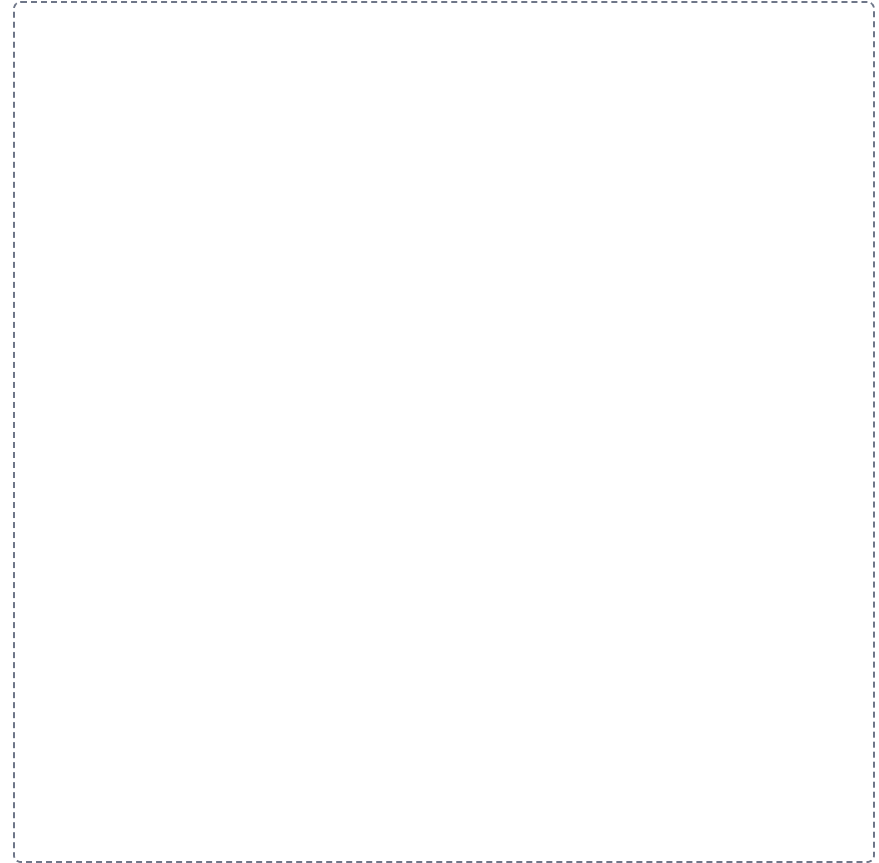
Draw a grid. List the things being compared down the left side, write the features you are comparing them on across the top, and fill in every box.



The nasal cavity

HUB

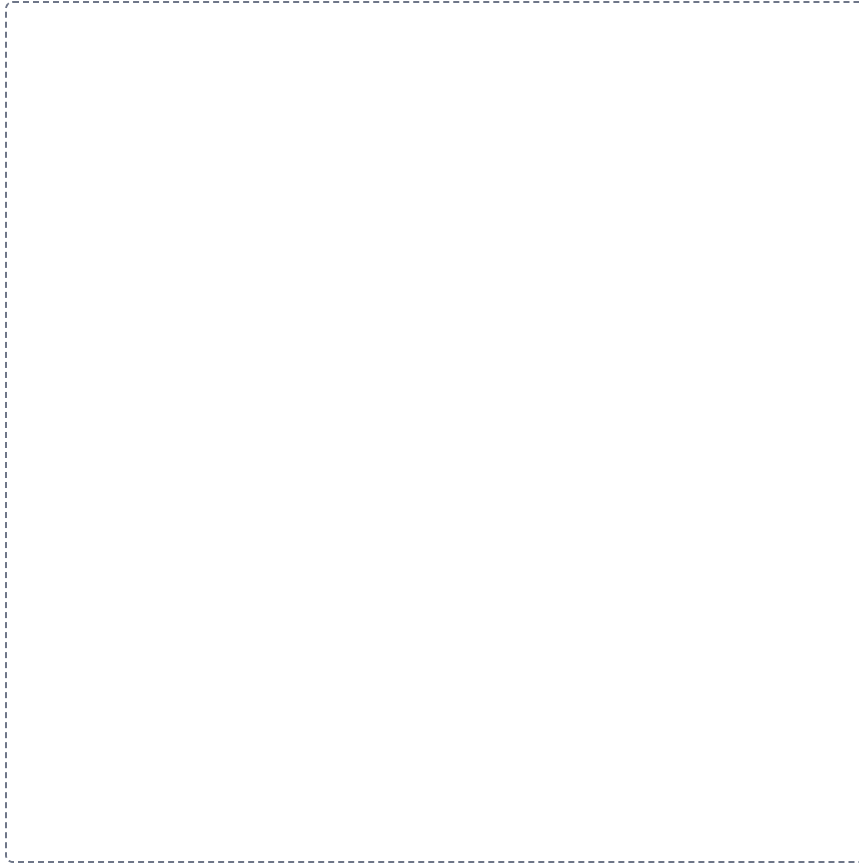
Put the main structure in the middle of the frame. Draw everything that belongs to it around the outside, label each one, and run a line from each back to the middle.



The three regions of the pharynx

LADDER

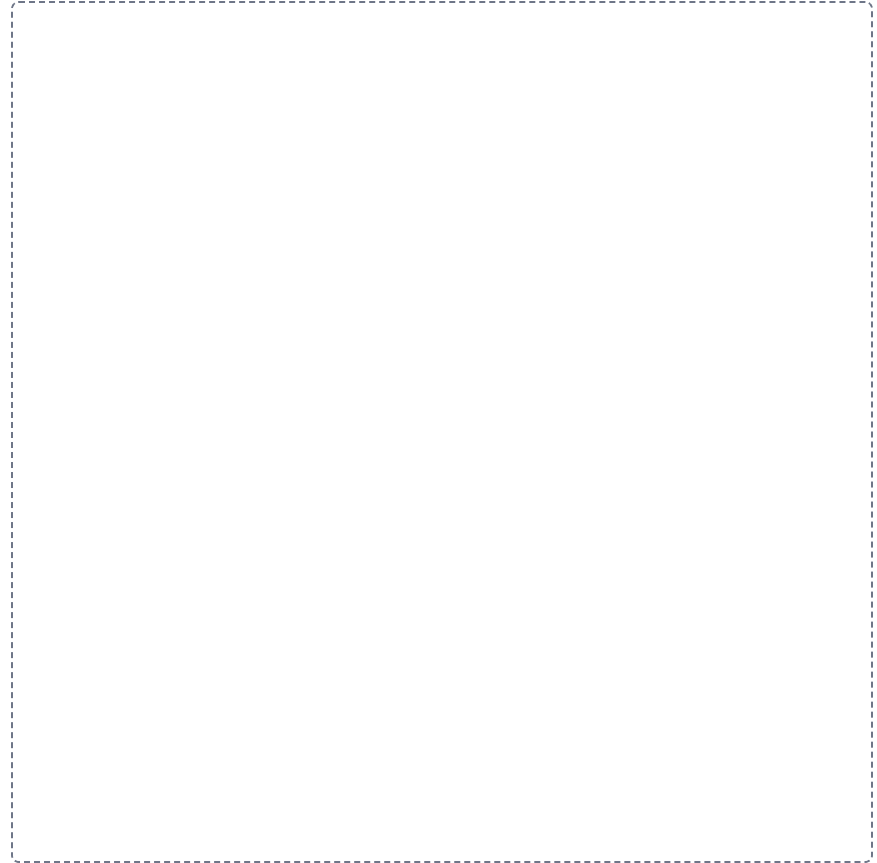
Draw the levels in order down the frame, the first one at the top. Label each level and write one line saying how it differs from the level above it.



The larynx

HUB

Put the main structure in the middle of the frame. Draw everything that belongs to it around the outside, label each one, and run a line from each back to the middle.

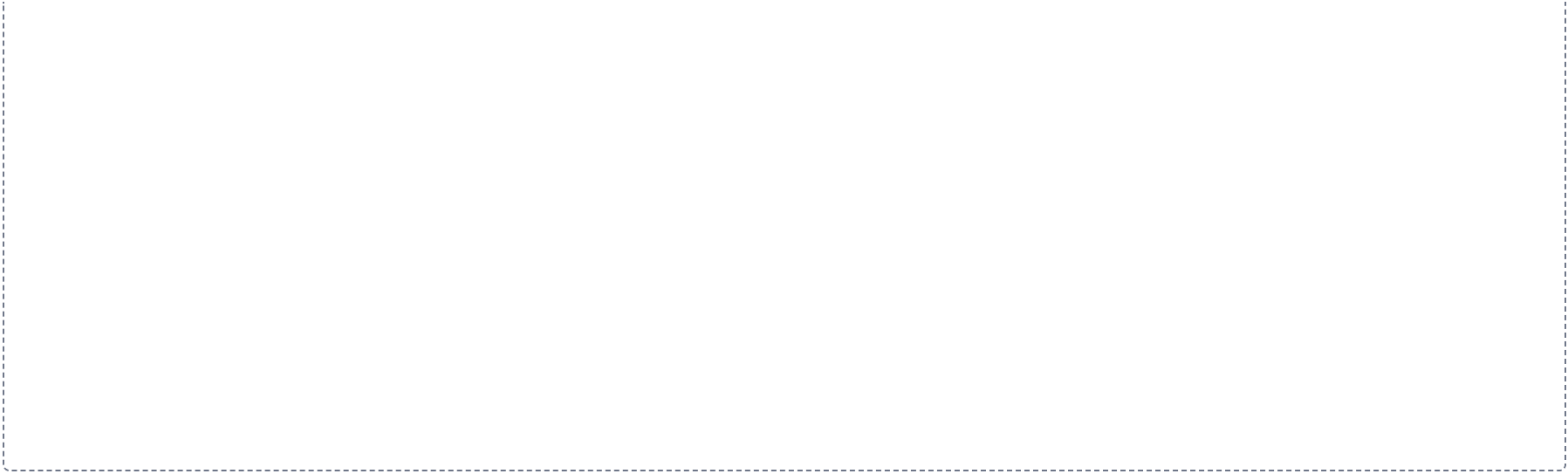


The airway, trachea to alveolus

CHAIN

Draw the steps left to right with an arrow between each one. Label every step, and on each arrow write what happens to get to the next.

A large dashed rectangular box intended for a student to draw a flowchart showing the steps from the trachea to the alveolus. The box is empty and occupies most of the page below the instructions.

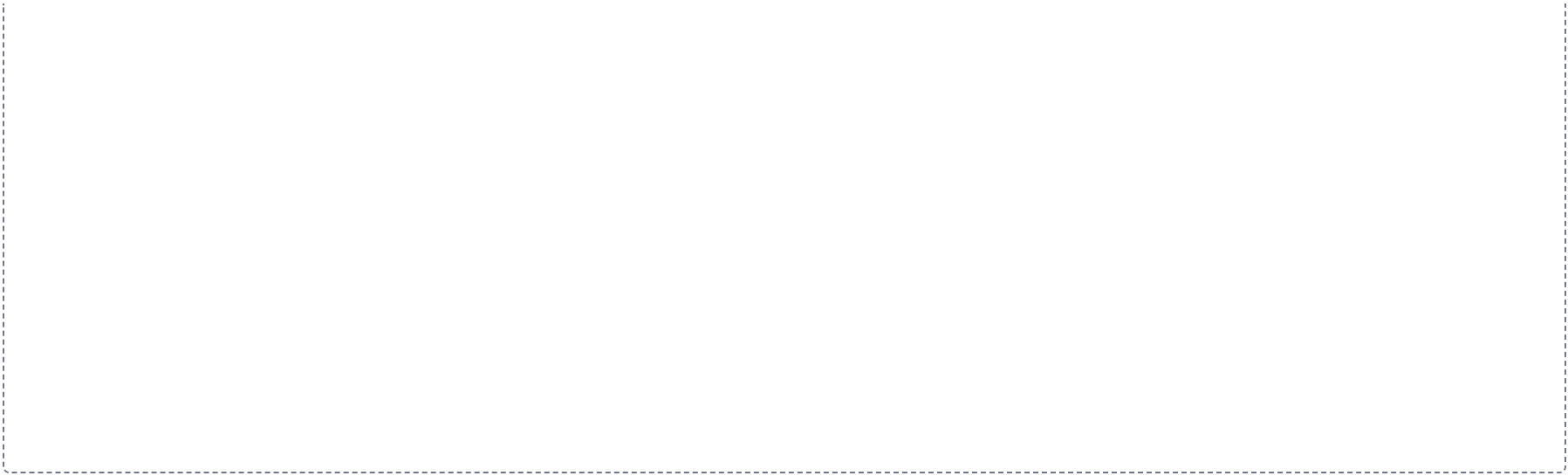


Right lung against left lung

SPLIT

Draw a line down the middle of the frame. Put one on the left and the other on the right. Draw and label both, then underneath write the one difference that tells them apart.



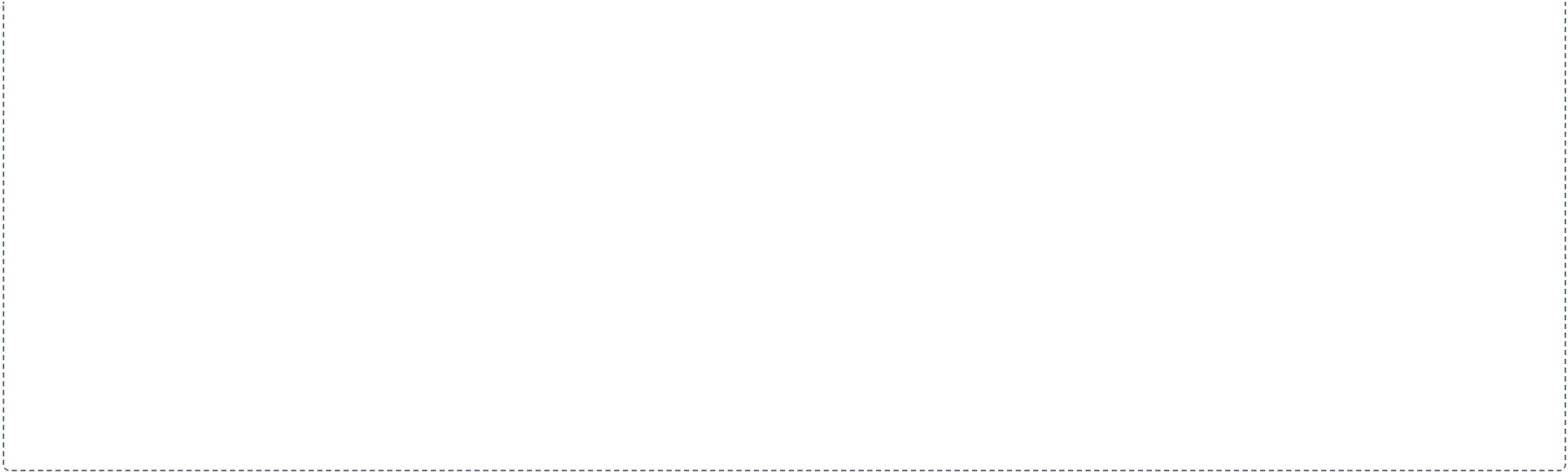


The pathway of lymph, tissue space to bloodstream

CHAIN

Draw the steps left to right with an arrow between each one. Label every step, and on each arrow write what happens to get to the next.



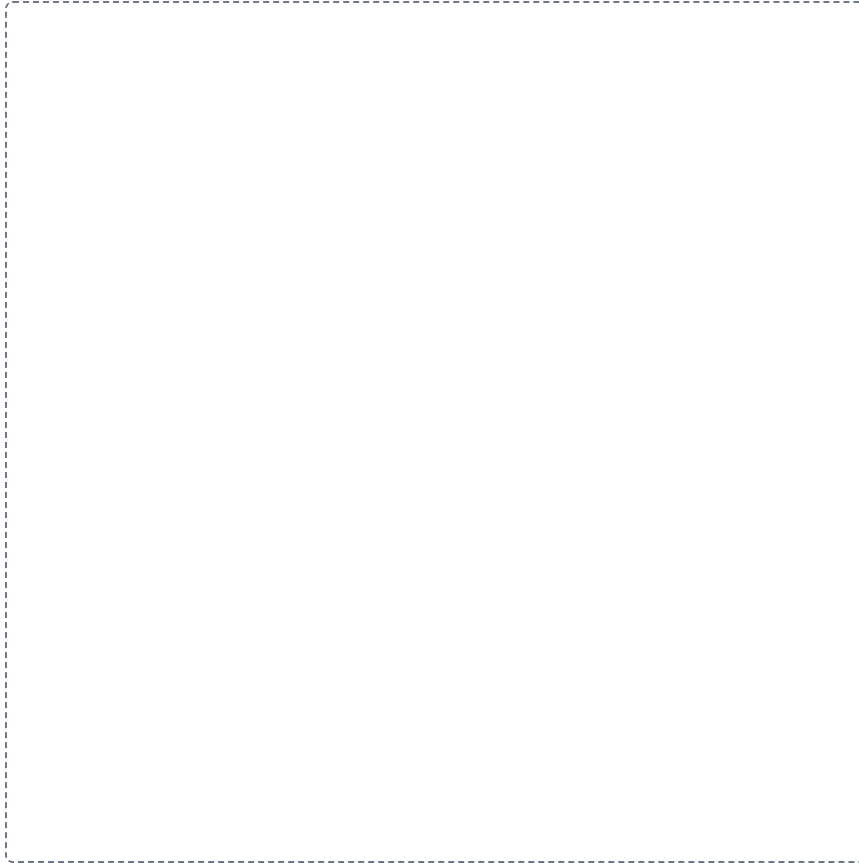


14-1

A lymph node

HUB

Put the main structure in the middle of the frame. Draw everything that belongs to it around the outside, label each one, and run a line from each back to the middle.



14-2

Primary against secondary lymphatic organs

GRID

Draw a grid. List the things being compared down the left side, write the features you are comparing them on across the top, and fill in every box.

